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Toward an AI-assisted Comprehensive Meta-analysis of the Organizational Commitment Literature

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the
**SYNTHESIS
COMPANY**
of CALIFORNIA

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The team behind this AI-assisted meta-analysis



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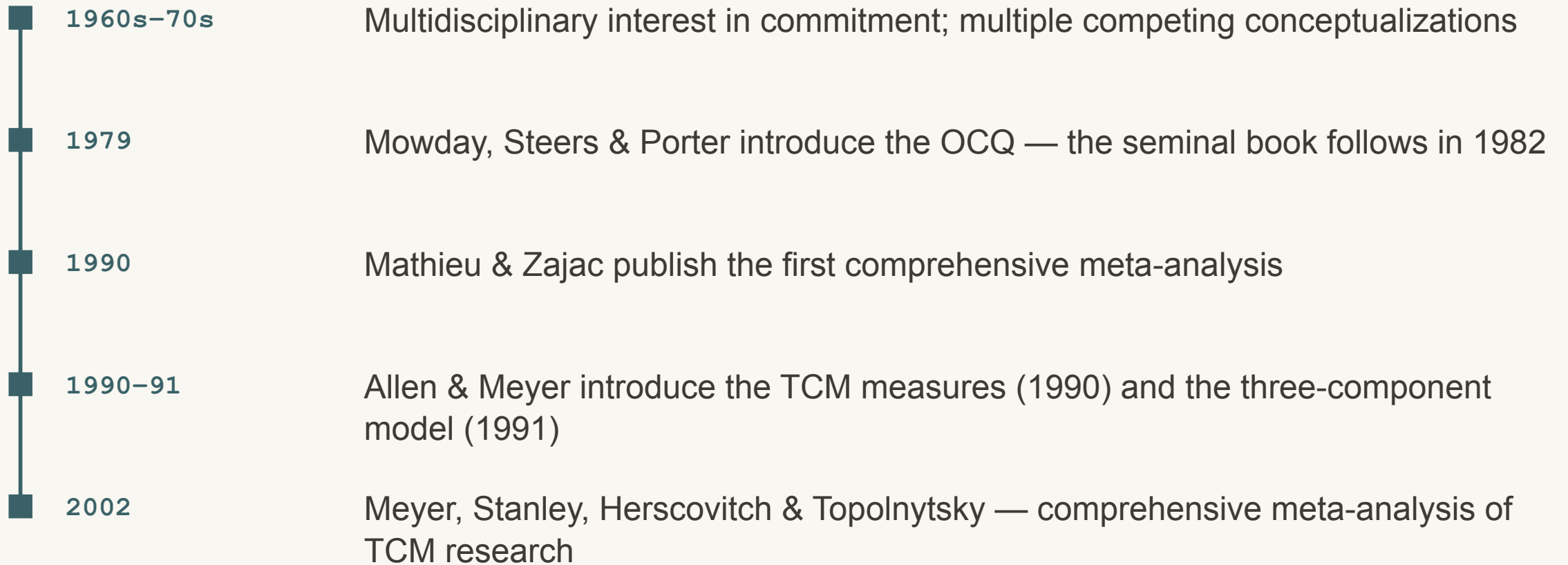
Agenda

Where we've been, where we are, and where this is going

- Brief History of Commitment Theory & Research
- Challenges to conducting comprehensive reviews
- Toward an AI-Assisted Meta-Analysis
 - Where we are
 - Where we are going
 - What is possible

Organizational commitment: the early years

A brief history — some milestones



Two comprehensive meta-analyses

Studies (**k**) and participants (**N**) per analysis — Mathieu & Zajac (1990) and Meyer et al. (2002)

1990

Mathieu & Zajac (1990)

STUDIES PER ANALYSIS (**k**)

3–43

PARTICIPANTS PER ANALYSIS (**N**)

302–15,531

VARIABLES META-ANALYZED **48**



2002

Meyer et al. (2002)

STUDIES PER ANALYSIS (**k**)

3–69

PARTICIPANTS PER ANALYSIS (**N**)

441–23,656

VARIABLES META-ANALYZED **38**



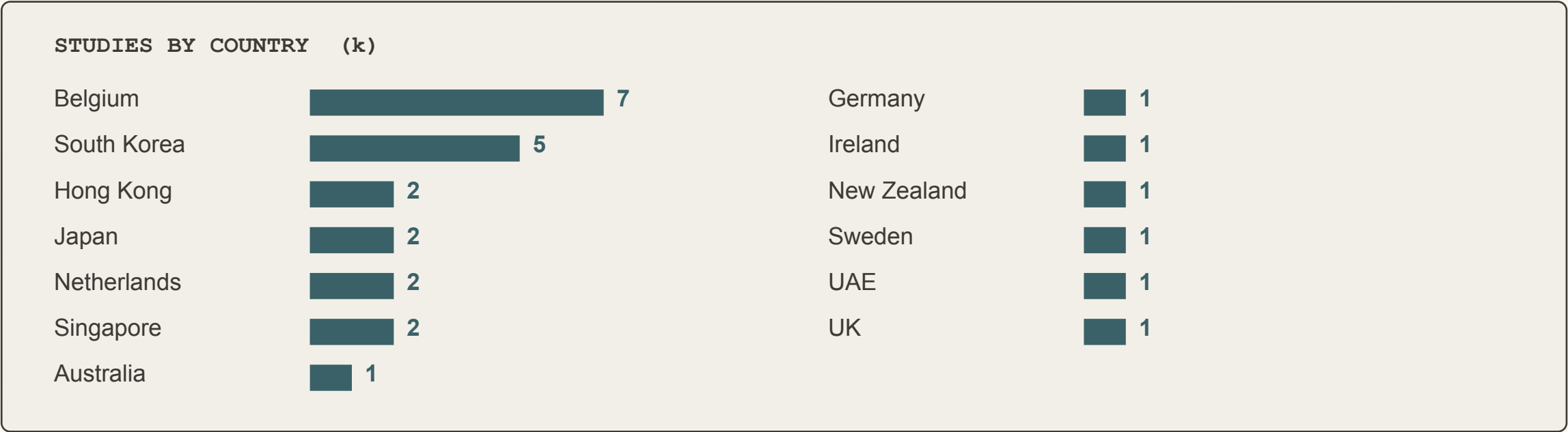
■ antecedents ■ correlates ■ consequences

A modest cross-national base

Meyer et al. (2002) — studies reporting country of origin

■ GEOGRAPHIC REACH OUTSIDE NORTH AMERICA

13 countries · 27 studies



Studies reporting country of origin (n = 27); tabulation from the ICAP 2014 presentation.

Challenges to conducting comprehensive reviews

Why a truly comprehensive commitment review has become impractical by hand.

1

Studies keep growing

Commitment research piles up faster every decade.

2

Reviews turn narrow

Meta-analyses cover fewer variables to stay feasible.

3

Even narrow is too much

Now even targeted reviews outstrip human capacity.

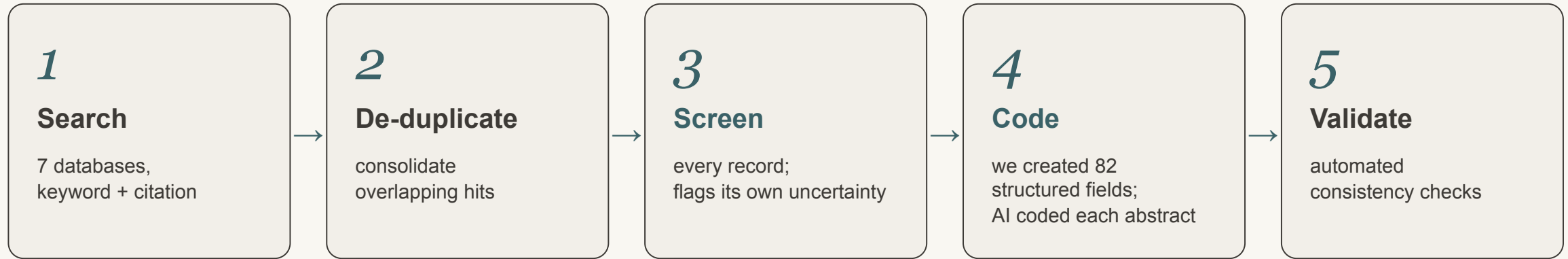
4

AI shares the labour

AI screens and codes at scale, clearing the bottleneck.

An AI-assisted pipeline — with humans in the loop

Screening and coding were performed by Eva, a family of AI agents; the team set the rules and decided every uncertain case.



HUMANS STAY IN THE LOOP

- Set & refine the inclusion rules
- Decide every case the AI flags as uncertain
- Pilot-review the coding before each full run

The AI does the volume; the team sets the rules and owns the judgment calls.

FINDING THE STUDIES

Literature Search

A Global Search

Literature search method

Two complementary search strategies in every database (except ERIC)

- **Keyword & subject-term search** — truncated organizational terms (org*, work*, employ*, job*, firm*, institution*, affect*, norm*, continu*) within three words of commit*, plus each database's subject headings; syntax adapted to each platform.
- **Cited-reference search** — every record citing any of 14 foundational commitment works (e.g., Porter et al., 1974; Mowday et al., 1979; Allen & Meyer, 1990; Meyer & Allen, 1991; Meyer et al., 2002; Klein et al., 2014).
- **Scholarly sources only** — academic journals, books, dissertations & theses, conference papers, reports, and working papers.
- **All languages** — the search applied no language restriction, so abstracts in any language were captured, not only English.

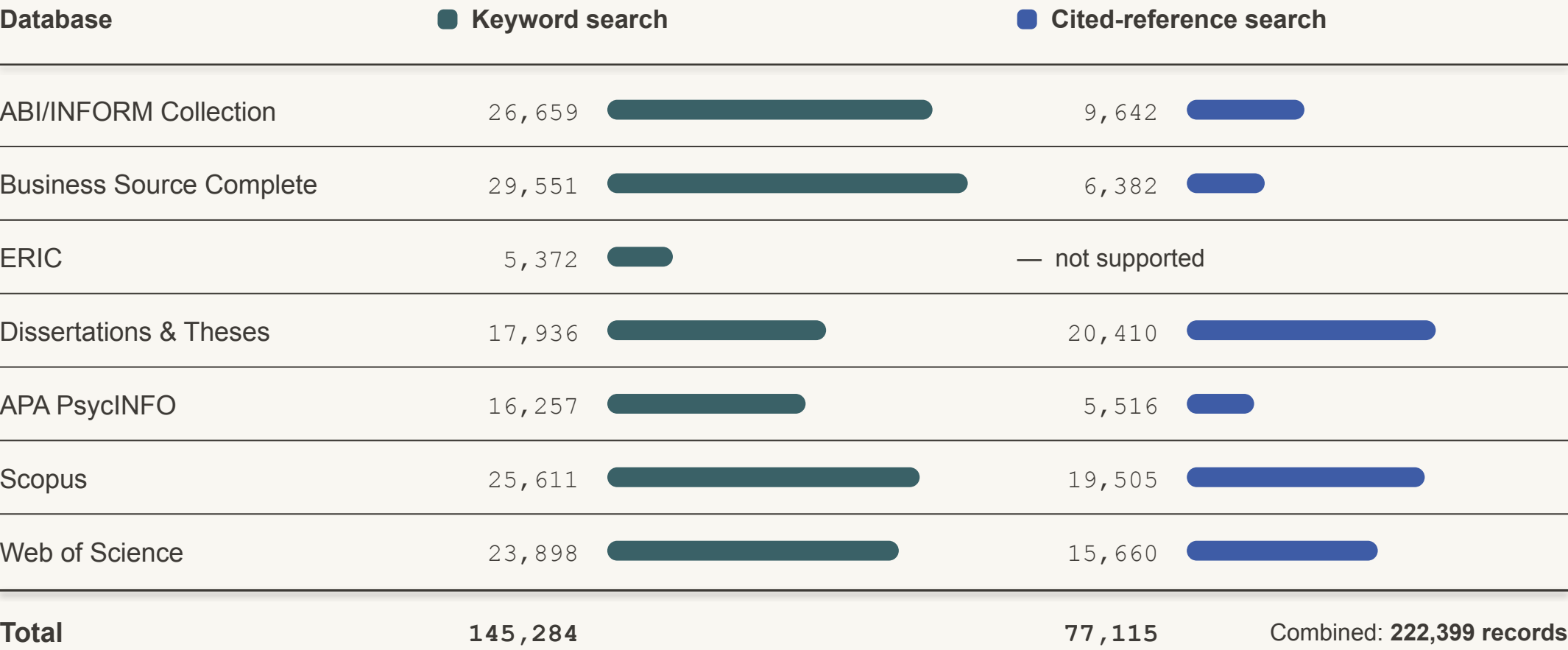
Seven databases

Searched December 20, 2025 – January 7, 2026

ABI/INFORM Collection	ProQuest
Business Source Complete	EBSCO
ERIC	Ovid · keyword only
Dissertations & Theses	ProQuest
APA PsycINFO	Ovid
Scopus	Elsevier
Web of Science	Clarivate

Records identified, by database and search strategy

Records retrieved per database, before consolidation and de-duplication · bars share one scale



ERIC (Ovid) does not support cited-reference searching.



Retrieved to Coded

De-duplication only removes overlap — AI relevance screening did the real narrowing

222,399 records retrieved
7 databases · keyword + citation



▼ de-duplication — *removes duplicate hits only*

113,643 unique records
after de-duplication



▼ **AI relevance screening by the Eva family of agents** — on each record's title & abstract

22,484 coded abstracts
22,605 relevant; 121 had no abstract to code



Only ~20% of unique records passed AI relevance screening (22,605 of 113,643) — the rest were off-topic, not duplicates.

How accurate is AI screening? — from prior research

■ Relative Screening Accuracy

97.2% **91.6%**
AI expert humans

of relevant studies kept in rather than missed
5 meta-analyses · 30,150 abstracts screened

■ Time saving with AI

≈ 72×

faster than screening by hand

36 hours of hand screening, done by the AI in under 30 minutes.
One of the five · 2 reviewers + 1 adjudicator · AI: a single pass

■ How the accuracy was measured

The AI and the human team each screened every title and abstract, deciding relevant or not. Where the two disagreed, the record was re-checked to establish which studies genuinely belonged. The figure shown is the percentage of those relevant studies a method correctly kept in rather than missed, averaged across the five datasets.

[Mehr, A., Howard, J. L., Nouroozi, C., Khorramnazari, B., Banks, G. C., Tay, L., Cuijpers, P., Miguel, C., Harrer, M., Meyer, J. P., Stanley, D. J., Wang, X., Luo, G., Huo, B., Liu, J., & Rousseau, D. M. \(2026\). *Improving Evidence Synthesis with Artificial Intelligence* \[Preprint\].](#)

WHAT THE CODED ABSTRACTS REVEAL

Abstract Analysis

How the literature has grown — and what it studies.

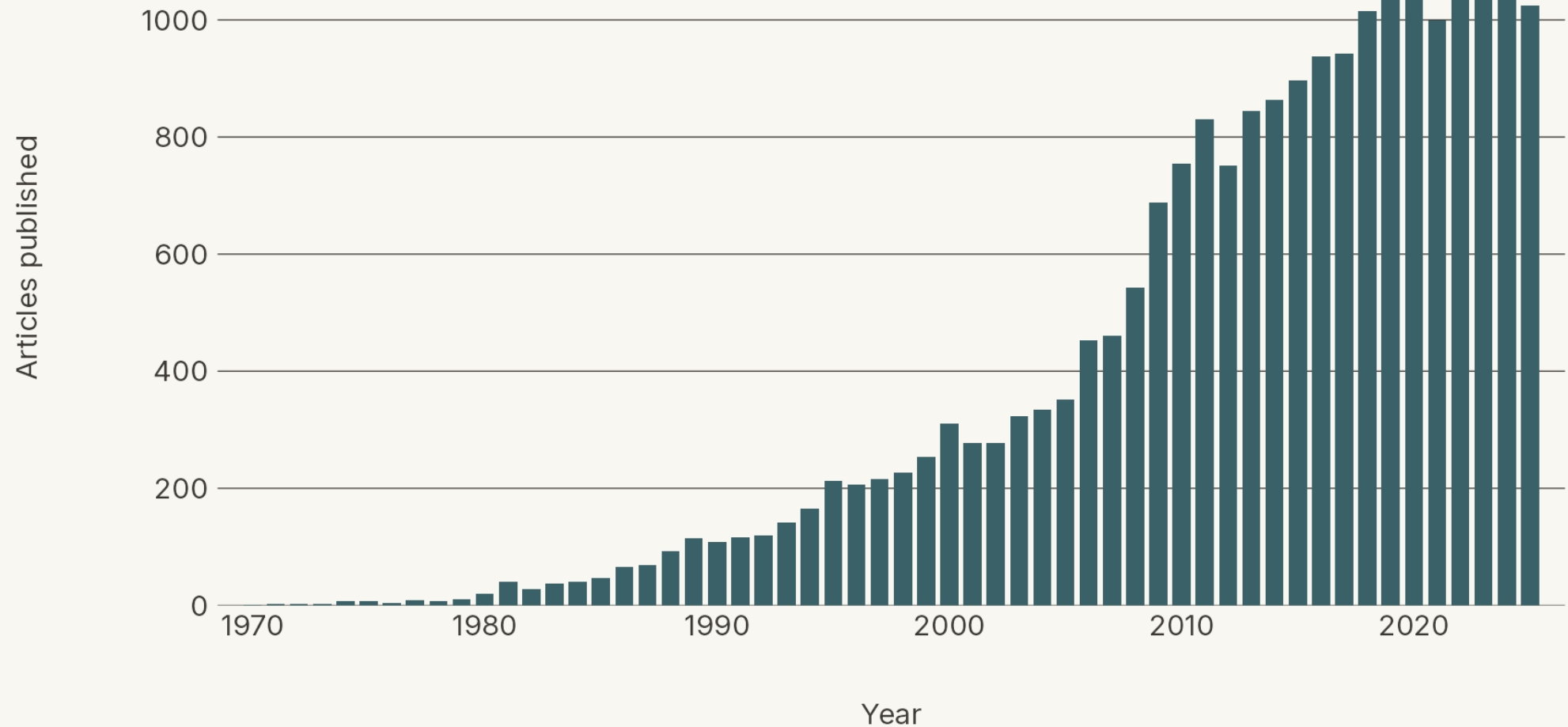


How quickly has the literature on organizational commitment grown?

Here's the count of articles published **per year**.

Articles Published Per Year

Annual count of unique abstracts, 1970–2025 (n = 21,753 of 22,484)

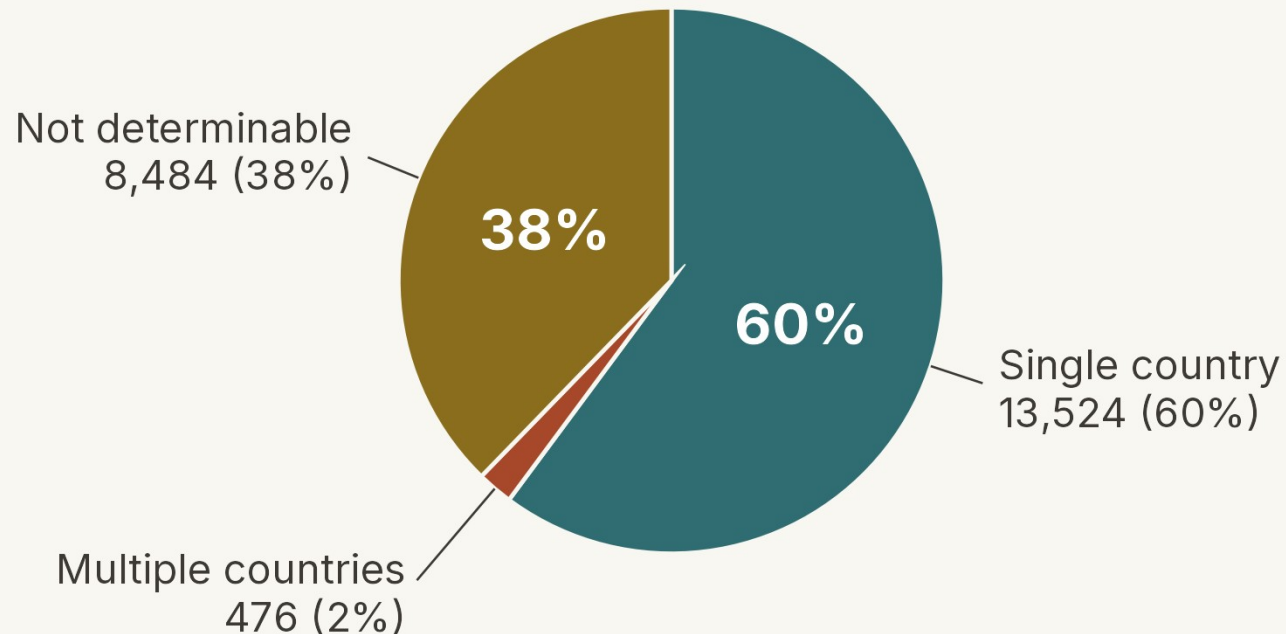




How has research on organizational commitment spread around the world over five decades?

In what countries were the data obtained?

Country-coding status across all 22,484 unique abstracts



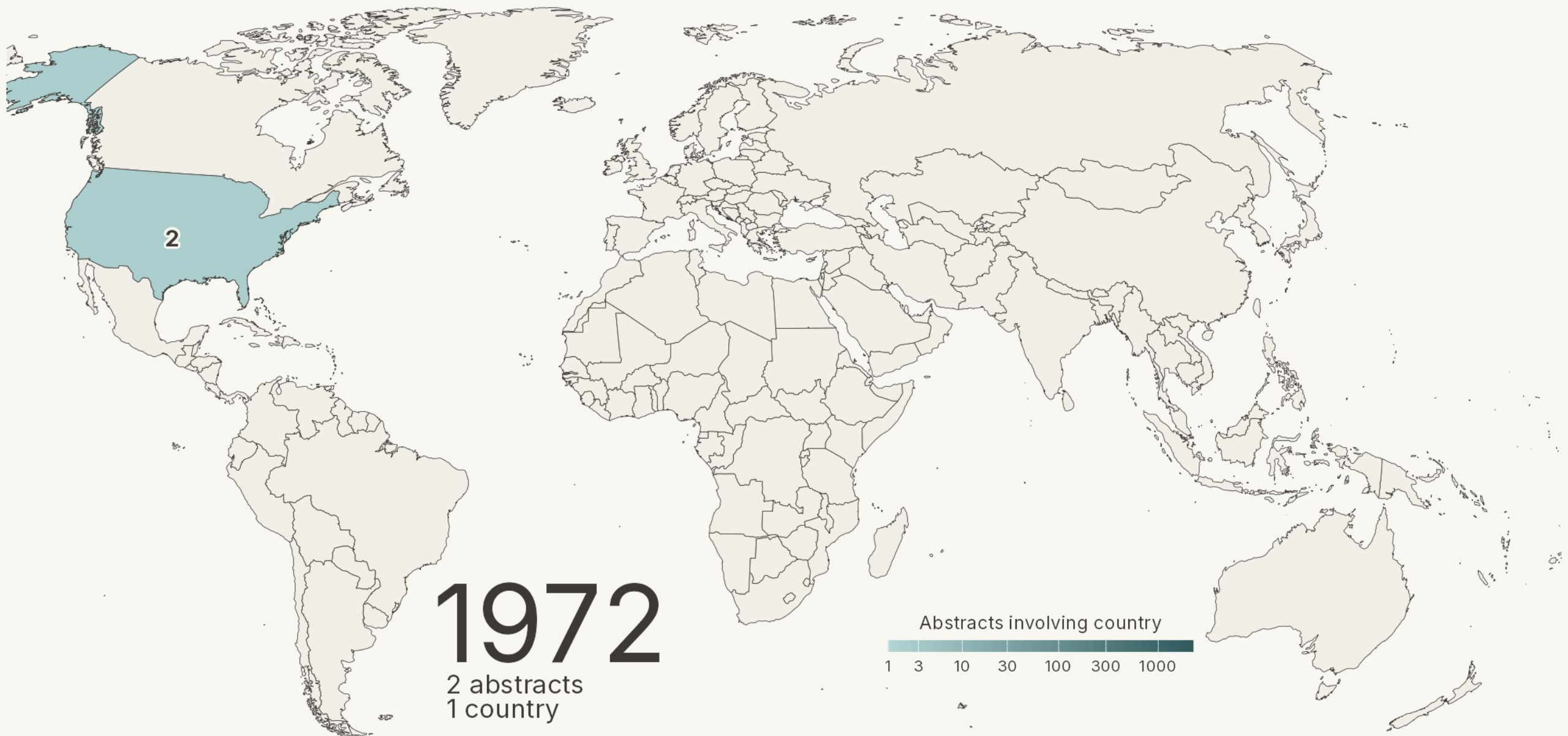
How country of origin was determined

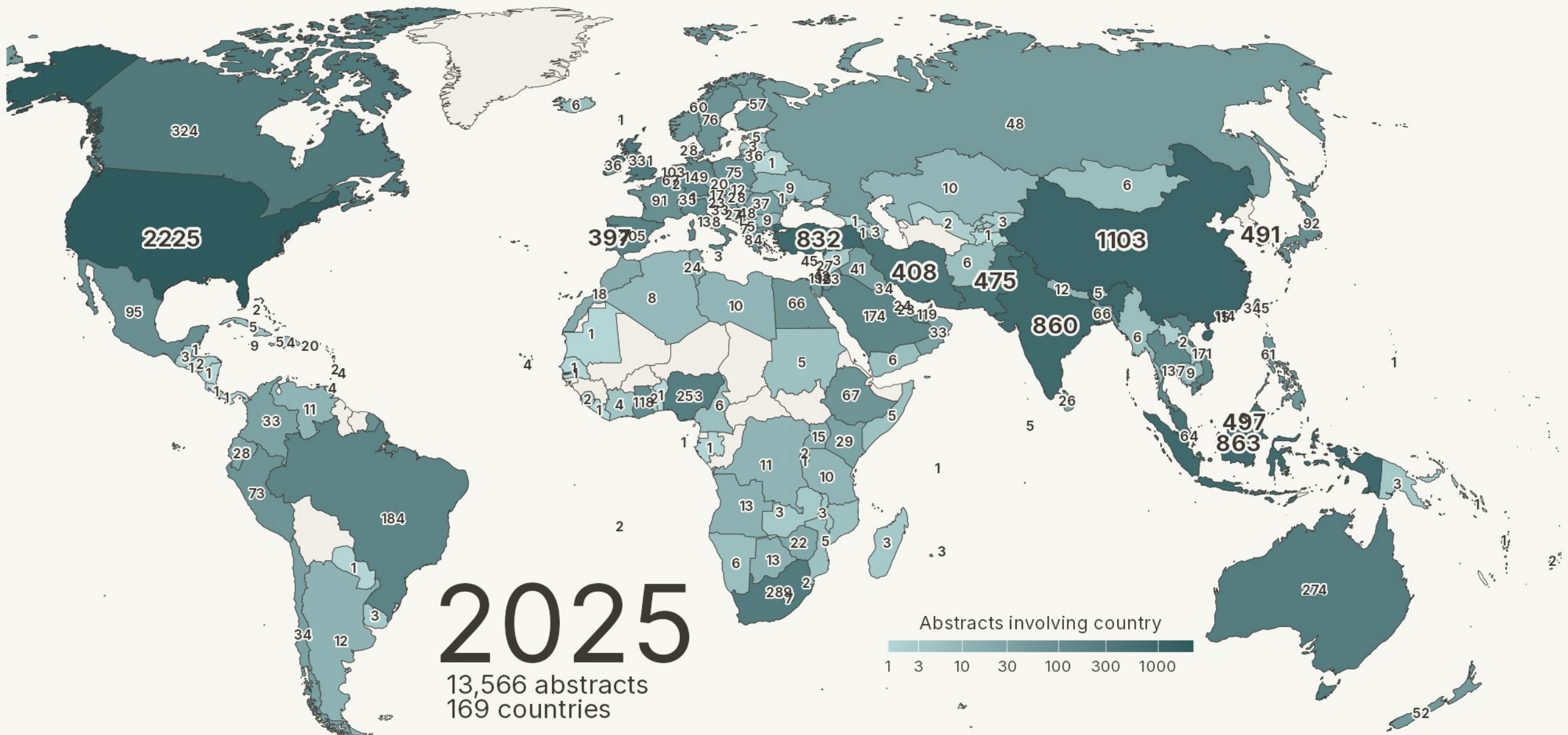
Country coding criteria (each YES / NO):

- Is a country named directly in the abstract?
- Does a stated city or region map to a country?
- Does a named company or organization map to a country?
- Do all authors' affiliations point to the same country?

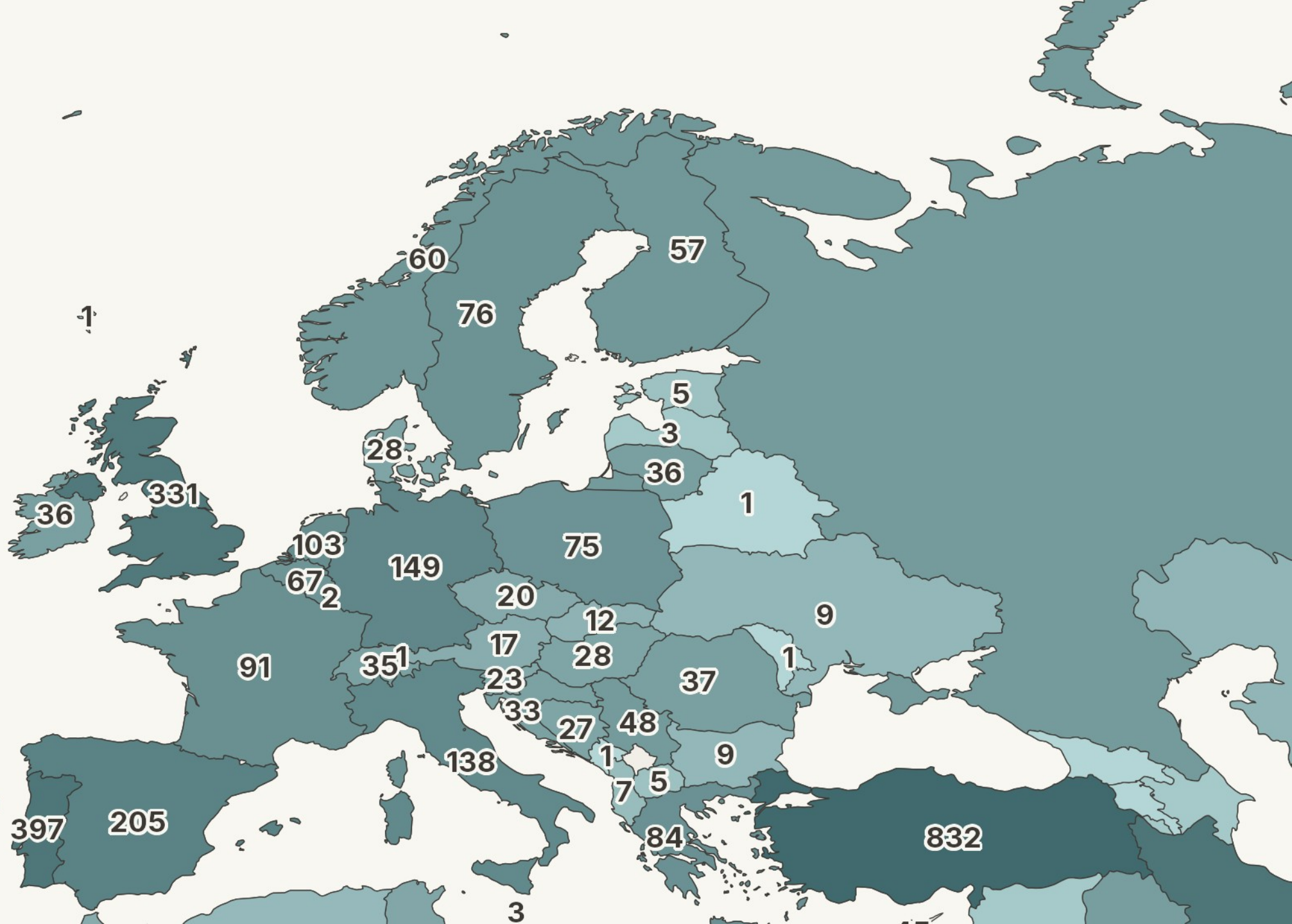
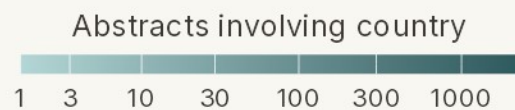
Recovering undetermined cases:

- For undetermined cases, author affiliations were retrieved from OpenAlex via DOI lookup and passed to the model, resolving 14 previously undetermined items.



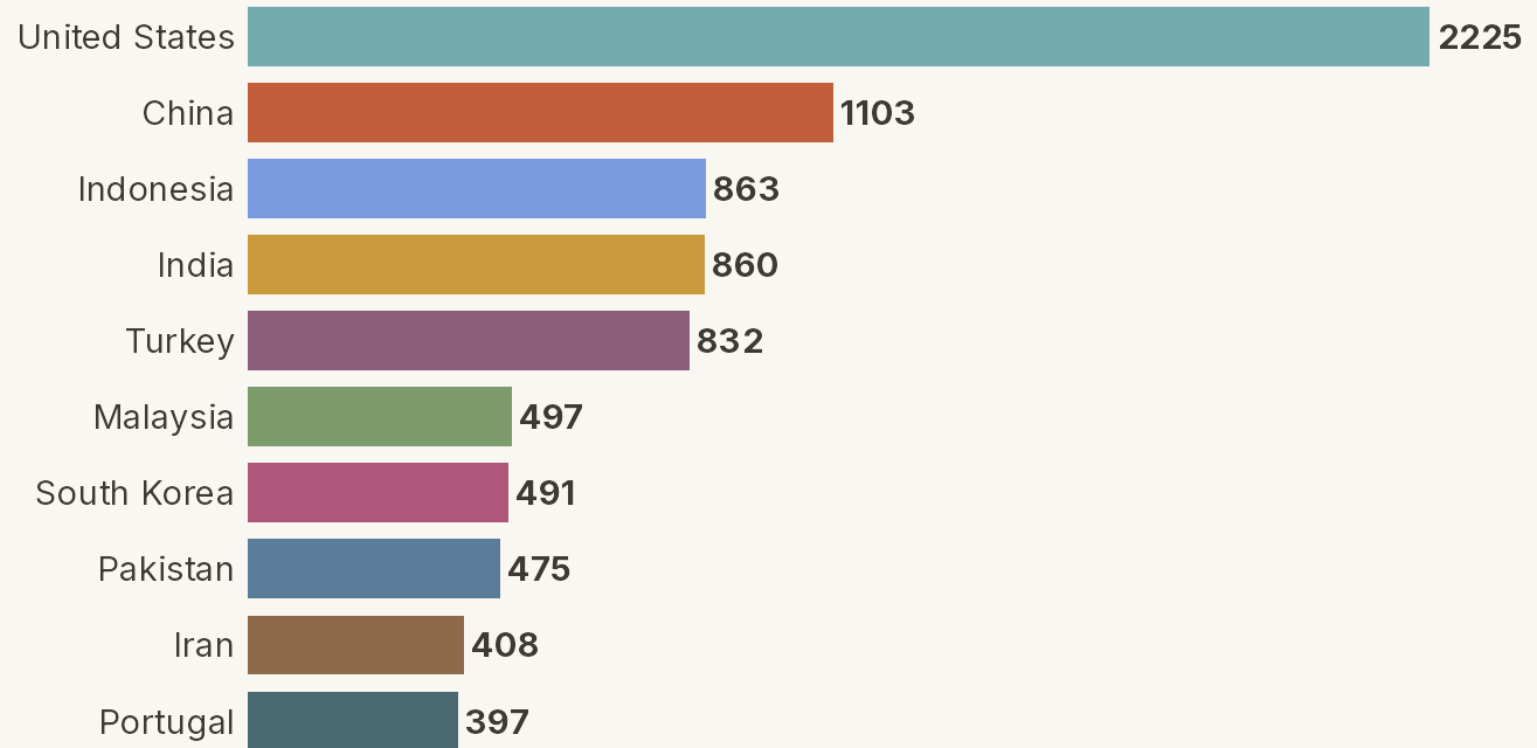


2025



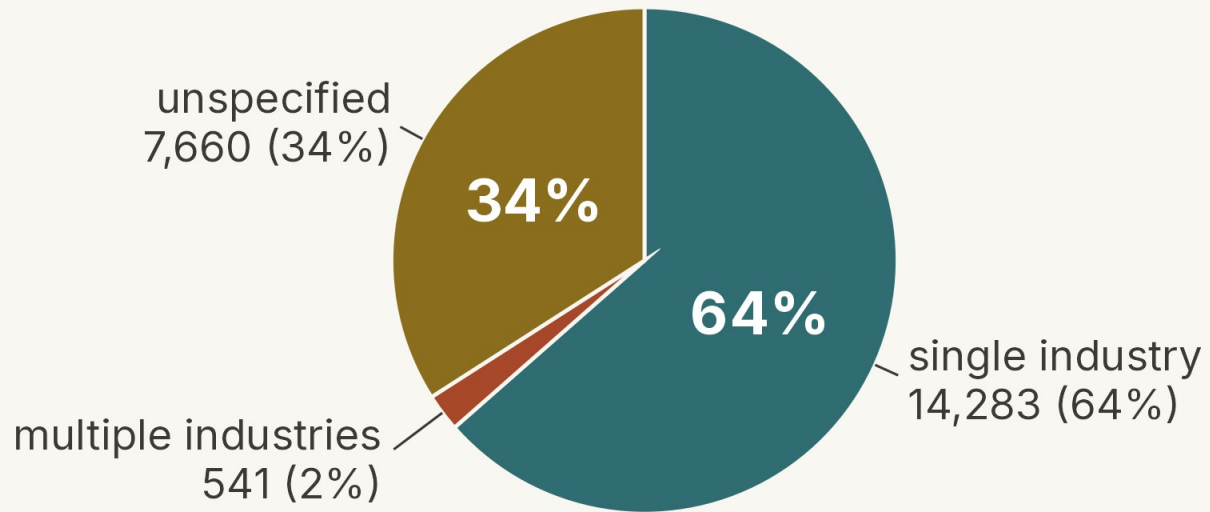
Top 10 Countries by Cumulative Samples

2025



What Industries have been Studied

Full coded sample, N = 22,484

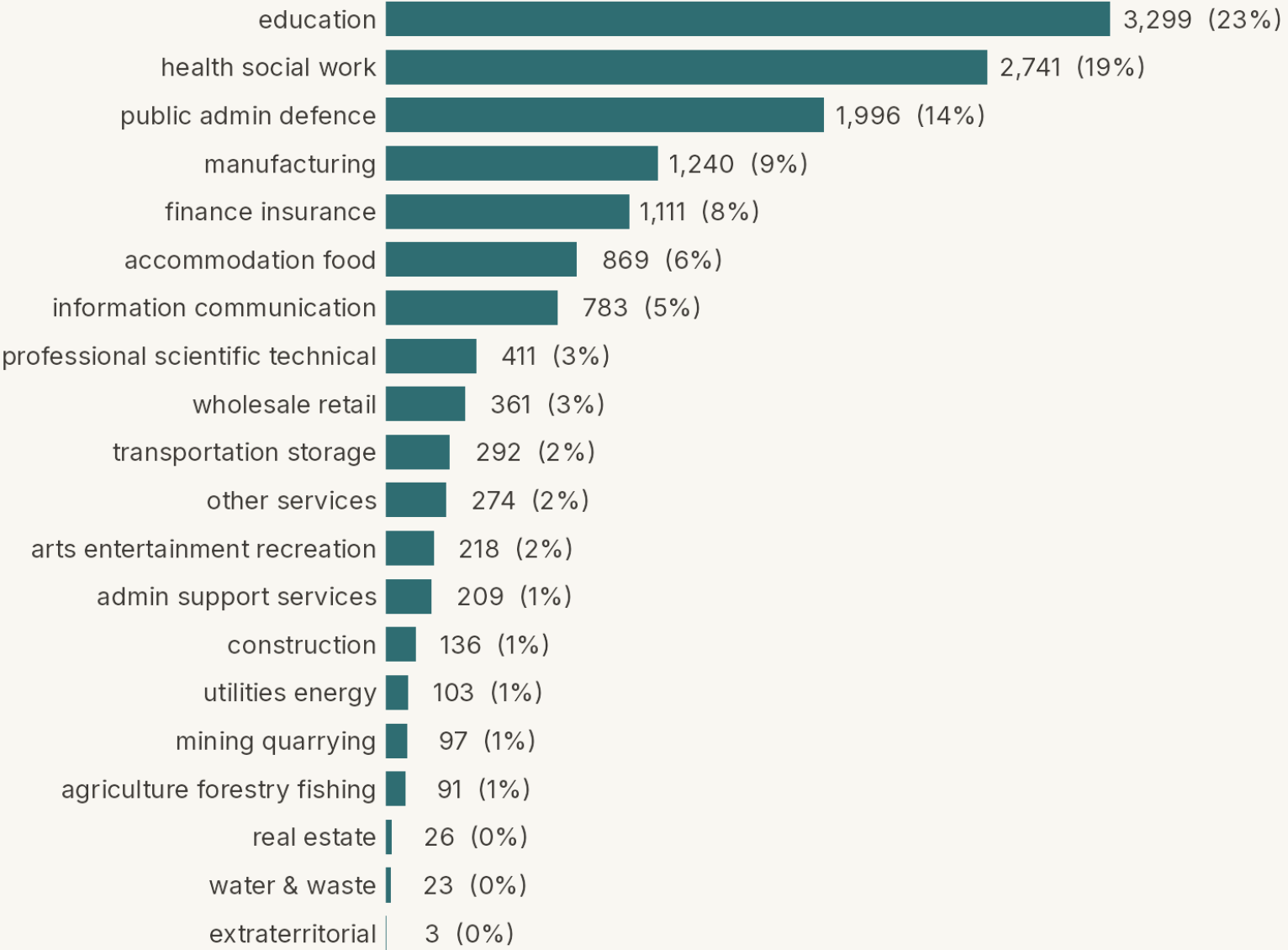


Industry taxonomy — ISIC Rev. 4

The UN's standard industry taxonomy — 21 letter-coded sections, A (agriculture, forestry & fishing) through U (extraterritorial organizations).

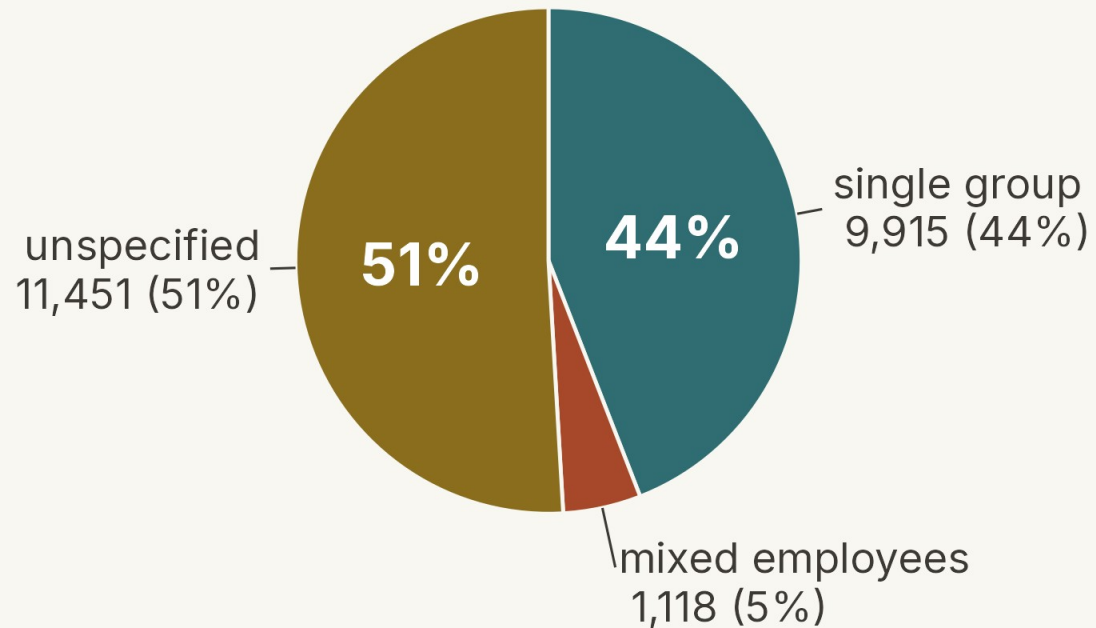
[Taxonomy Details Website](#)

Industry — distribution among single-industry studies



What Occupations have been Studied

Full coded sample, N = 22,484



Occupation taxonomy — ISCO-08

The ILO's standard occupation taxonomy (the counterpart to ISIC) — 10 major groups, 0 (armed forces) through 9 (elementary occupations).

[Taxonomy Details Website](#)

Occupation — distribution among single-occupation studies



How is organizational commitment positioned in the literature?

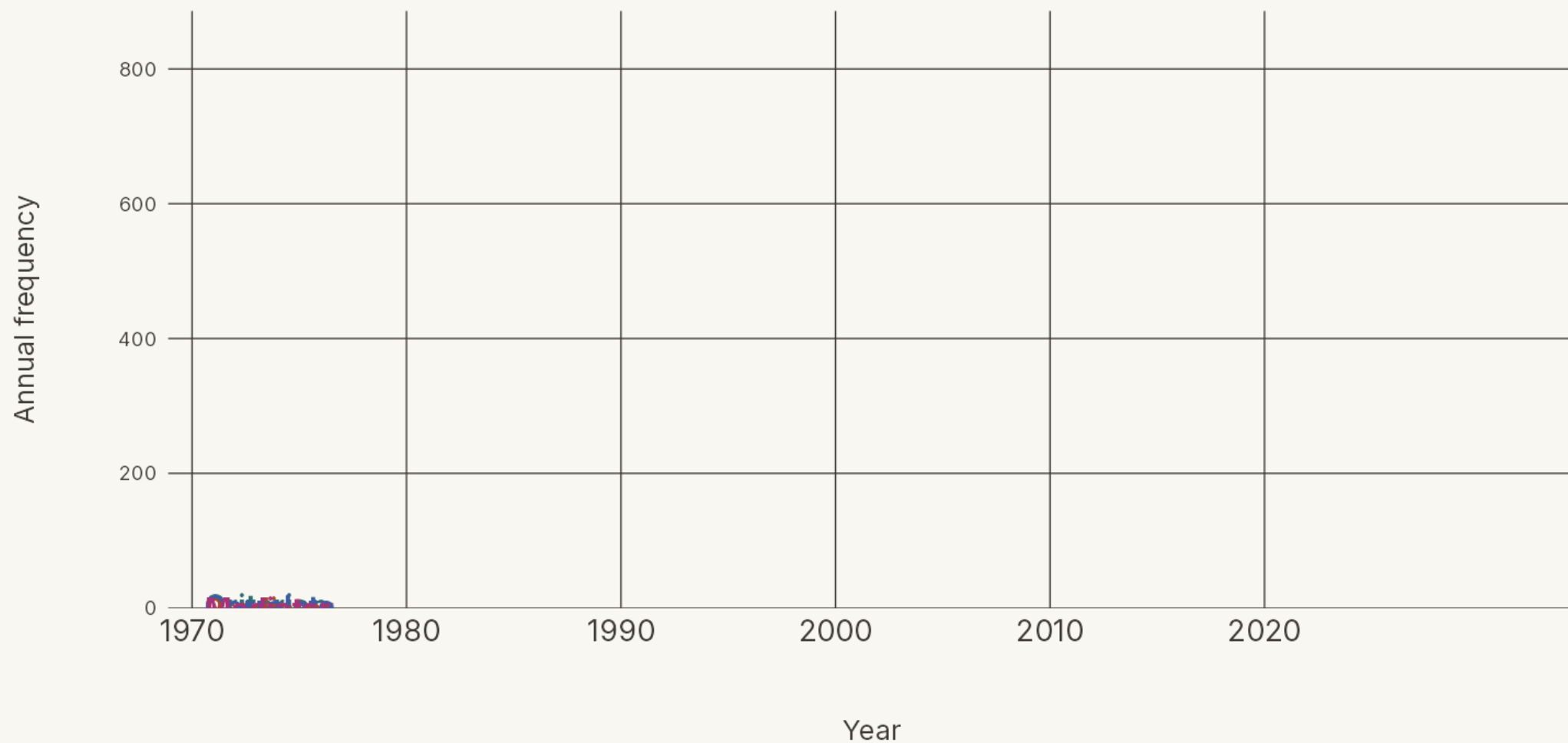
It plays four primary roles — as a predictor, a criterion, a correlate, and a mediator — and the balance has shifted over time.

How the four roles were assigned

We trained the AI to build a path model from each abstract's text. A variable's position in that path model determined which of the four roles it plays.

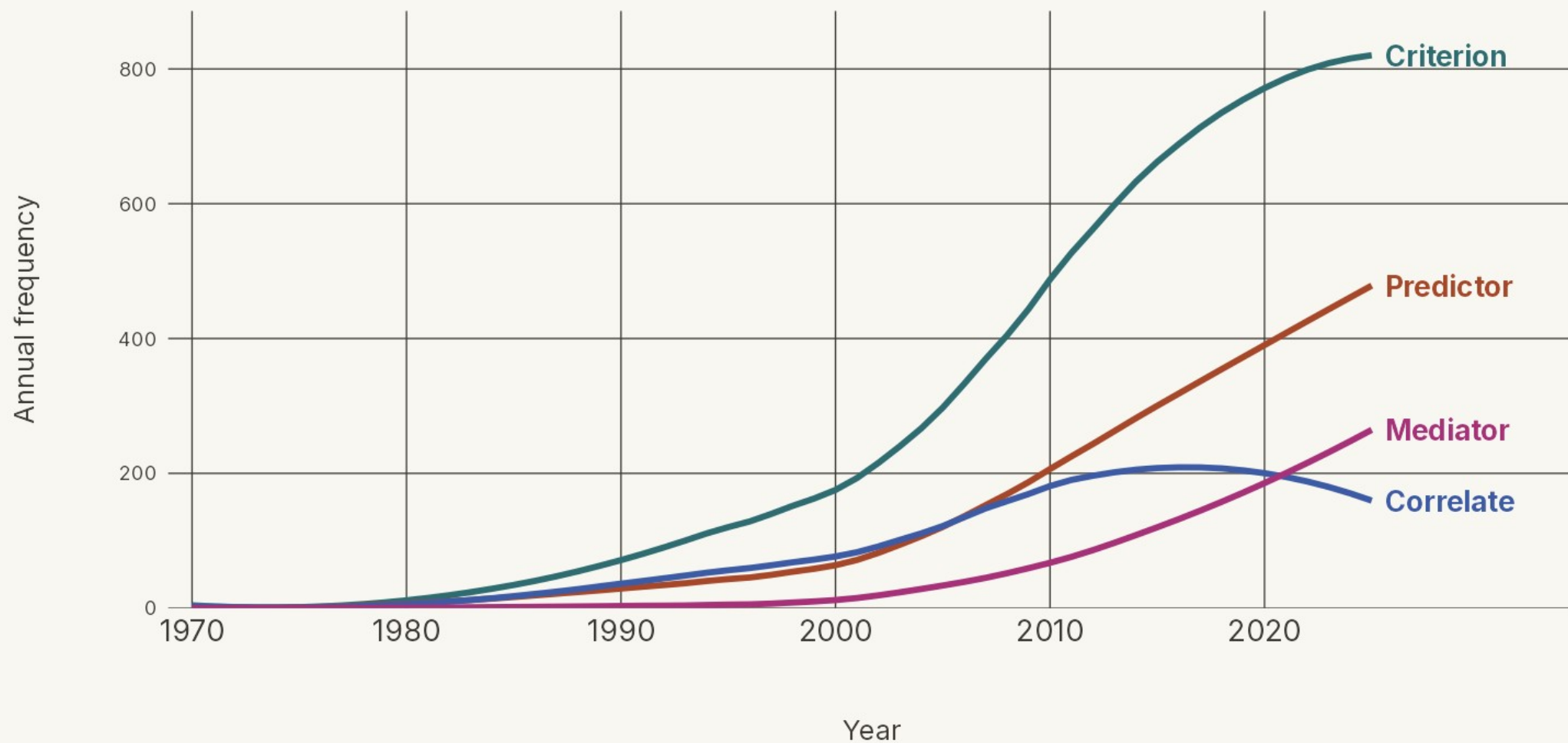
How 'organizational commitment' is positioned

Annual count of abstracts using commitment in each role



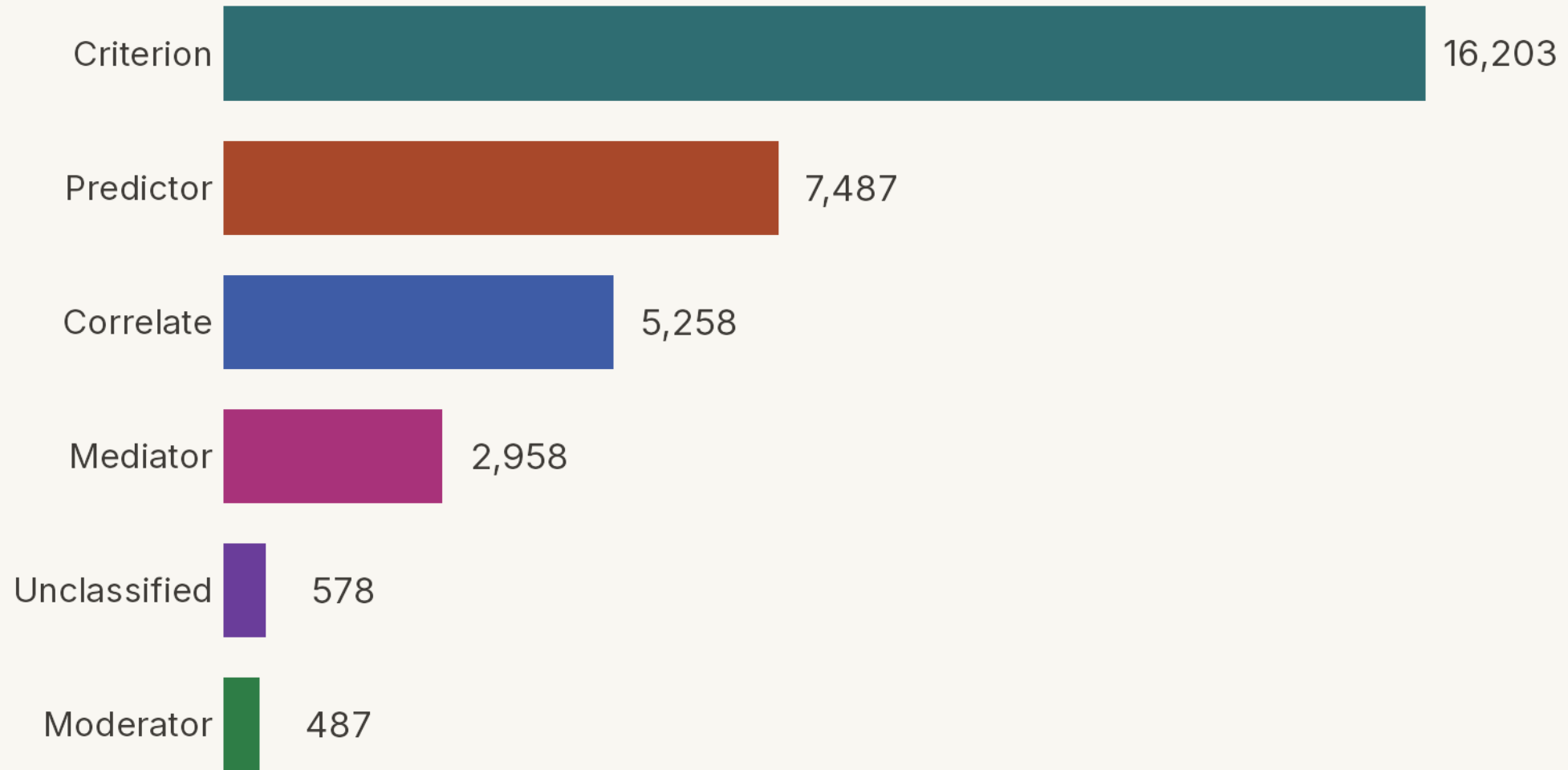
How 'organizational commitment' is positioned

Annual count of abstracts using commitment in each role



How 'organizational commitment' is positioned — all six roles

Total studies coded in each role — a study can hold several, so bars exceed the 22,484 coded



—

What variables served as predictors and criteria for commitment?

How did we identify and combine variable labels

STEP

1

Extract the raw labels

Direct extraction of the coded text,
“as is.”

STEP

2

Merge plural / spelling variants

Combine simple plural and spelling variants (e.g., “policies” → “policy”).

STEP

3

Group by meaning

Predictors: the AI proposed the families.

Outcomes: we supplied them; the AI sorted labels in.

Steps 2 and 3 by hand would be formidable tasks — AI makes them manageable.

How many distinct variables did we extract?

After merging spelling and plural variants — before grouping by meaning

Step 2

Merge plural / spelling variants

Predictors of commitment

14,390

distinct variables

Outcomes of commitment

3,320

distinct variables

One construct, every language

For every study, the AI extracts the variables it examines — reading the abstract in its own language — and records each under one English label, so studies in any language pool into the same construct.

■ As written across languages

job satisfaction

工作满意度

satisfação no trabalho

iş tatmini

satisfacción laboral

satisfaction au travail

직무 만족

الرضا الوظيفي

English

Chinese

Portuguese

Turkish

Spanish

French

Korean

Arabic

■ The unified label

job_satisfaction

one English label · **2,085** studies pooled

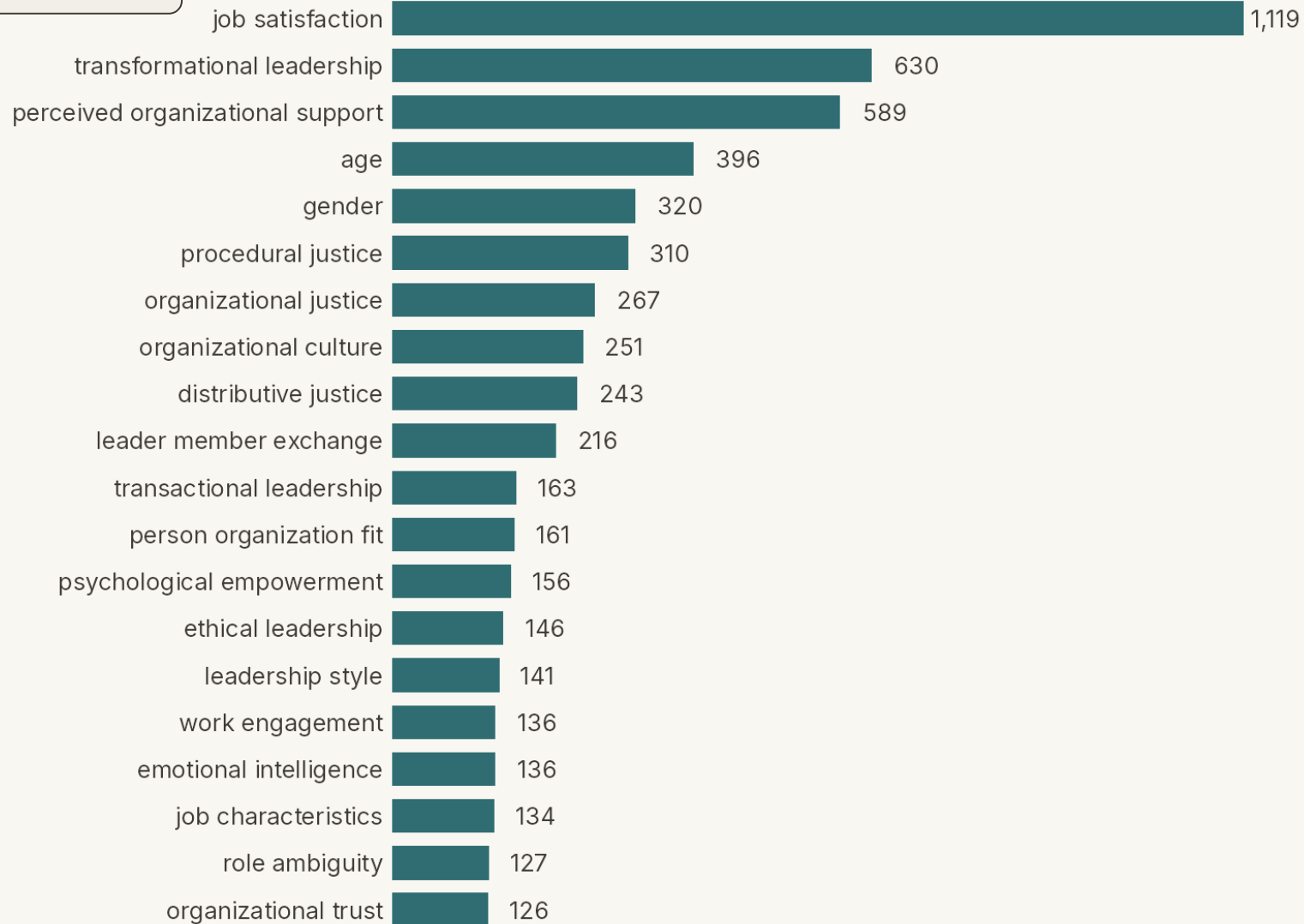
The alternative — human coding — would either **miss the non-English articles** or require **hiring multiple language-proficient coders**. The AI needs neither.

Step 2

Merge plural / spelling variants

Top 20 predictors of organizational commitment

Of 14,390 distinct predictor variables (light combining) — bar length = distinct studies naming each



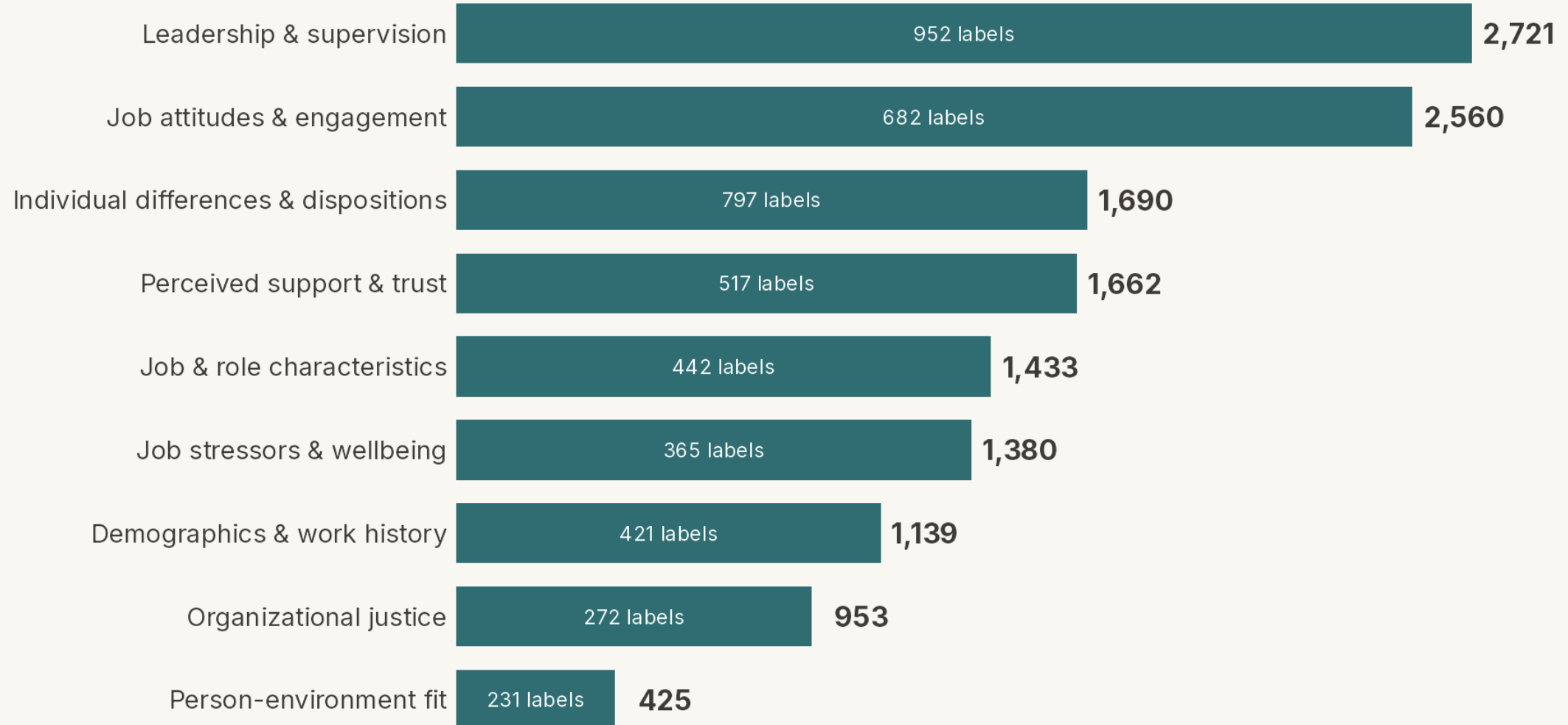
Step 3

Group by meaning

Predictors of organizational commitment, in nine categories

Bar & end label = distinct studies naming ≥ 1 predictor in the category.

Inside each bar = number of variable labels collapsed into it. ("Other" not shown.)

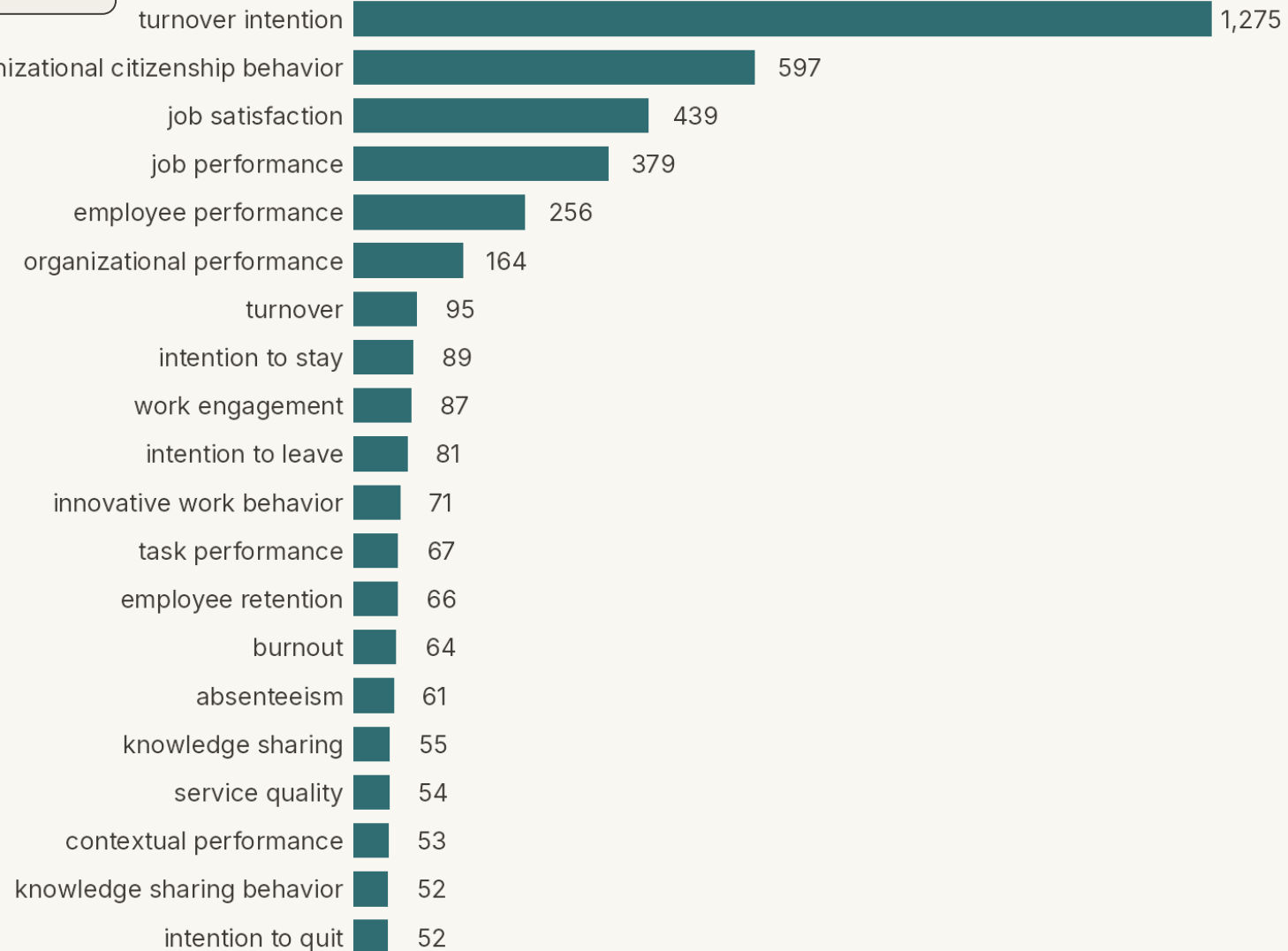


Step 2

Merge plural / spelling variants

Top 20 outcomes of organizational commitment

Of 3,320 distinct outcome variables (light combining) — bar length = distinct studies naming each



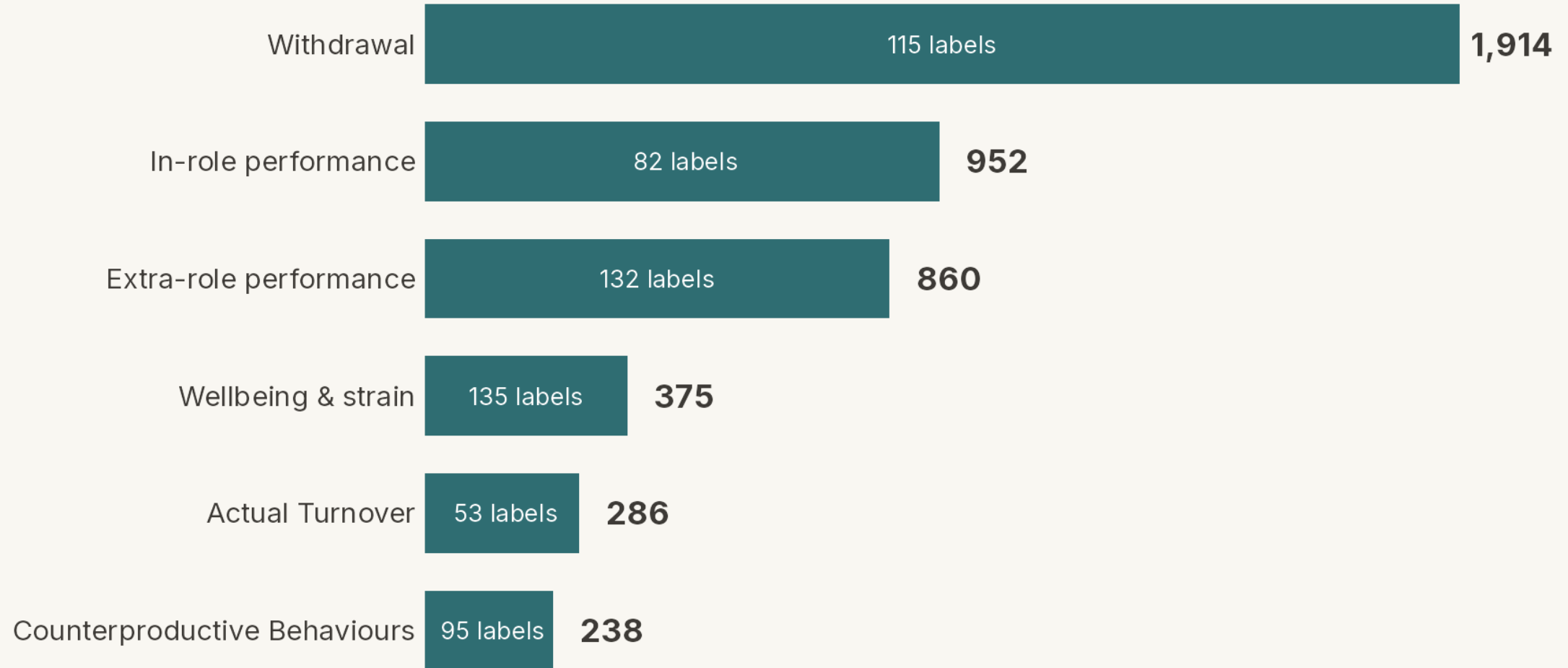
Step 3

Group by meaning

Outcomes of organizational commitment, in six categories

Bar & end label = distinct studies naming ≥ 1 outcome in the category.

Inside each bar = number of variable labels collapsed into it.



Top 20 correlates of organizational commitment

Of 4,030 distinct correlate variables (light combining) — bar length = distinct studies naming each



FROM ABSTRACTS TO ANALYSIS

Next Steps

The work ahead, in four steps.

How accurate is AI coding? — from prior research

■ Relative Coding Accuracy

97.0% **92.1%**
AI expert humans

of extracted values confirmed correct
4 meta-analyses · 632 studies · 20,476 data points

■ Time saving with AI

≈ 32×

faster than coding by hand

130 hours of hand coding, done by the AI in about 4 hours.
One meta-analysis: 12,025 numbers from 390 studies · one coder.

■ How the accuracy was measured

The AI and the human team each extracted every value independently. Matches were counted correct; disagreements were re-checked against the source article by an expert to decide which side was right. Each method's accuracy is the percentage of values confirmed correct, averaged across the four datasets.

[Mehr, A., Howard, J. L., Nouroozi, C., Khorramnazari, B., Banks, G. C., Tay, L., Cuijpers, P., Miguel, C., Harrer, M., Meyer, J. P., Stanley, D. J., Wang, X., Luo, G., Huo, B., Liu, J., & Rousseau, D. M. \(2026\). *Improving Evidence Synthesis with Artificial Intelligence* \[Preprint\].](#)

Next steps

From the coded abstracts to a completed meta-analysis — four steps from here.

1

Download the articles

Retrieve the full texts behind the coded abstracts.

2

Code the articles

Extract effect sizes and study details from each.

3

Formalize the variable taxonomies

Finalize the construct groupings from these results.

4

Begin analyses

Run the meta-analytic models.



SCAN TO VIEW & SHARE THESE SLIDES

tinyurl.com/icap2026-commitment

The download includes a Methodological Deep Dive we didn't have time to present.

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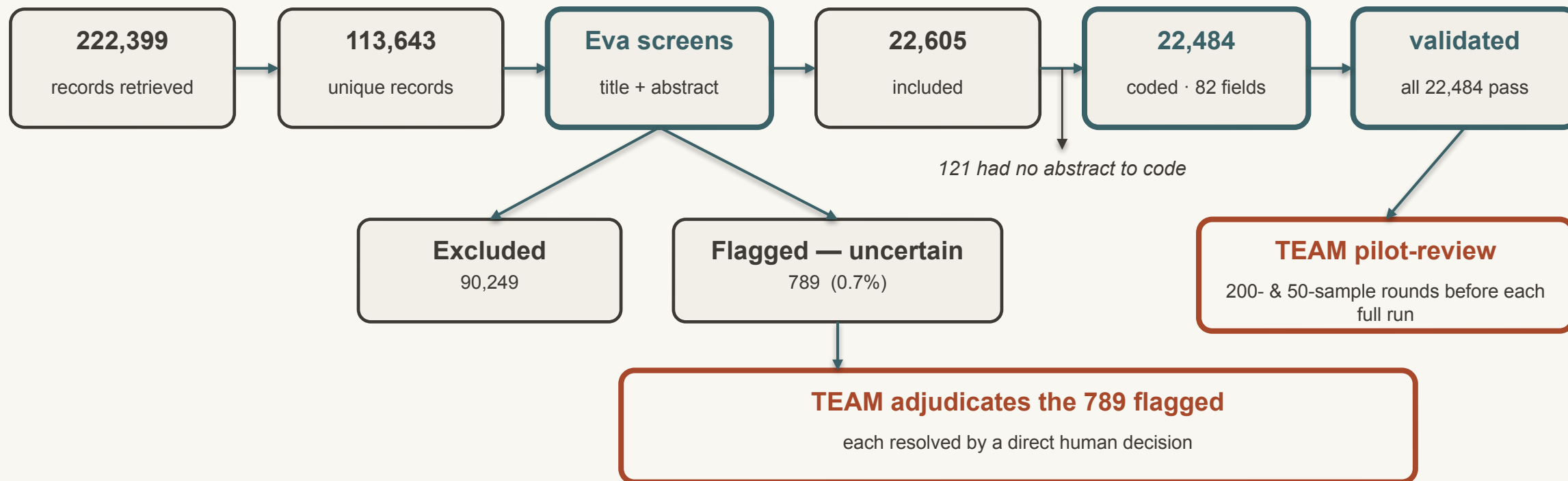
FOR READERS OF THE DOWNLOADED SLIDES

Methodological Deep Dive

The pipeline, calibration, coding scheme, and full counts — detail we skip in the talk.

The workflow, end to end

Every record's path — the fan-out at screening, and the human decisions, made explicit



 automated (Eva)

 human (team)

 record counts

The pipeline in full

Every record's path from retrieval to coded abstract — human steps marked in brown

1	Retrieve	222,399 records — 7 databases, keyword + cited-reference searches
2	De-duplicate	113,643 unique records after removing overlapping hits
3	Screen	Eva reads each record's title + abstract and applies 4 inclusion criteria — primary empirical, quantitative, organizational context, commitment measured: 22,605 include · 90,249 exclude · 789 flagged uncertain (0.7%)
4	Adjudicate	Team resolves the 789 cases the AI flagged as uncertain — each gets a direct human decision (the AI never guesses on them)
5	Code	22,484 abstracts (121 of the 22,605 relevant records had no abstract to code) — 82 structured fields each, with a verbatim quote per field
6	Validate	All 22,484 pass automated consistency checks; team pilot-reviews before each full run

Calibration & human oversight

Humans ran a blind spot-check, then concentrated effort on the cases the AI itself flagged as uncertain

STAGE	WHEN	WHAT HAPPENED
Initial alignment	Sep 2025	40 abstracts blind-reviewed — 39/40 agreement (the one mismatch was a case Eva had flagged uncertain). Adopted the rule: when in doubt, err toward inclusion.
Uncertain-case calibration	Jan–Feb 2026	195 records from ~5,400 uncertain cases, blind-reviewed by three team members. Disagreements traced to undefined rules (missing / non-English abstracts) — the reviewers disagreed too. Rules made explicit; the whole set re-screened → uncertain cases fell from ~5,400 to 789.
Uncertainty adjudication	Feb–Mar 2026	Team hand-reviewed the 789 cases the AI flagged as uncertain — each resolved by a direct human decision rather than an AI guess.
Coding pilot	May–Jun 2026	Codebook built with the team; a 50-sample review + async re-test surfaced 5 fixes (e.g., a mandatory path-diagram step, a level-of-analysis field). Only then the full 22,484 run.

Net: roughly 1% of the 113,643 records ever needed manual screening — concentrated exactly where the abstracts were genuinely ambiguous.

What was coded

82 structured fields per abstract — each carrying a verbatim quote as its evidence

PATH-MODEL FIRST

Eva drew each study's path model, located commitment within it, and only then assigned commitment's role — predictor, outcome, mediator, or moderator.

The 82 fields capture

- Commitment role (predictor / outcome / mediator / moderator)
- Commitment type (affective / continuance / normative)
- Level of analysis (individual / unit / organization)
- Country of data collection (4-level evidence hierarchy)
- Industry — ISIC Rev. 4
- Occupation — ISCO-08
- Every predictor, outcome, mediator & moderator variable
- Variable names normalized to standard English (any source language)

Evidence, not assertion — every field carries a verbatim quote from the abstract to support it.

The numbers — and where they come from

Counts are verified from this project's database; accuracy figures belong to the validation study

THIS PROJECT — DATABASE-VERIFIED

222,399 records retrieved

113,643 unique after de-duplication

22,605 included · 90,249 excluded

789 flagged uncertain — all human-adjudicated

~1% of records needed any manual screening

22,484 abstracts coded · 82 fields each

39/40 project blind-check agreement

FROM THE VALIDATION STUDY — MEHR ET AL.

Screening

97.2% / 91.6% vs expert human screeners

Coding

97.0% / 92.1% vs expert human coders

Tested on

5 meta-analyses · 30,150 screening documents

Sensitivity and specificity are properties of the validation study, not of this meta-analysis. This project reports only its own database-verified counts and the 39/40 blind-check.

SEED STUDIES FOR THE CITED-REFERENCE SEARCH

Foundational Works

What we mean by “foundational” — the studies whose citations we followed in the cited-reference search.

Foundational works

1 OF 2

The cited-reference search retrieved every record citing any of these 14 works

Allen, N. J., & Meyer, J. P. (1990). The measurement and antecedents of affective, continuance and normative commitment to the organization. *Journal of Occupational Psychology*, 63(1), 1–18.

Allen, N. J., & Meyer, J. P. (1996). Affective, continuance, and normative commitment to the organization: An examination of construct validity. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 49(3), 252–276.

Cook, J., & Wall, T. (1980). New work attitude measures of trust, organizational commitment and personal need non-fulfilment. *Journal of Occupational Psychology*, 53(1), 39–52.

Klein, H. J., Cooper, J. T., Molloy, J. C., & Swanson, J. A. (2014). The assessment of commitment: Advantages of a unidimensional, target-free approach. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 99(2), 222–238.

Meyer, J. P., & Allen, N. J. (1984). Testing the “side-bet theory” of organizational commitment: Some methodological considerations. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 69(3), 372–378.

Meyer, J. P., & Allen, N. J. (1991). A three-component conceptualization of organizational commitment. *Human Resource Management Review*, 1(1), 61–89.

Meyer, J. P., & Allen, N. J. (1997). *Commitment in the workplace: Theory, research, and application*. Sage Publications.

Foundational works

2 OF 2

The cited-reference search retrieved every record citing any of these 14 works

Meyer, J. P., Allen, N. J., & Smith, C. A. (1993). Commitment to organizations and occupations: Extension and test of a three-component conceptualization. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 78(4), 538–551.

Meyer, J. P., Stanley, D. J., Herscovitch, L., & Topolnytsky, L. (2002). Affective, continuance, and normative commitment to the organization: A meta-analysis of antecedents, correlates, and consequences. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 61(1), 20–52.

Mowday, R. T., Porter, L. W., & Steers, R. M. (1982). *Employee–organization linkages: The psychology of commitment, absenteeism, and turnover*. Academic Press.

Mowday, R. T., Steers, R. M., & Porter, L. W. (1979). The measurement of organizational commitment. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 14(2), 224–247.

O'Reilly, C. A., III, & Chatman, J. (1986). Organizational commitment and psychological attachment: The effects of compliance, identification, and internalization on prosocial behavior. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 71(3), 492–499.

Porter, L. W., Steers, R. M., Mowday, R. T., & Boulian, P. V. (1974). Organizational commitment, job satisfaction, and turnover among psychiatric technicians. *Journal of Applied Psychology*, 59(5), 603–609.

Powell, D. M., & Meyer, J. P. (2004). Side-bet theory and the three-component model of organizational commitment. *Journal of Vocational Behavior*, 65(1), 157–177.